

Academic Integrity Policy

Standards, Procedures, and Sanctions

Office of Academic Integrity

Effective August 17, 2026

CURRENT

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Fictional educational corpus. All names, contacts, programs, and rules are synthetic.

1. Prohibited Conduct

Academic misconduct includes plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, fabrication, falsification, cheating, facilitating another person's misconduct, and misrepresenting participation or attendance.

Use of generative artificial intelligence is governed by the course syllabus. When the syllabus is silent, students may use AI for brainstorming and language feedback but may not submit generated analysis, code, or prose as their own without disclosure and permission.

Reusing one's own prior submitted work without instructor approval is duplicate submission and may be misconduct even though the student created the original work.

- Course-specific AI rules control.
- Fabricated citations are misconduct.
- Helping another student cheat is prohibited.

Reference: NSU-INTEGRITY-2026 | CURRENT

2. Reporting and Initial Review

An instructor who reasonably suspects misconduct notifies the student in writing and offers a meeting. The notice identifies the work and alleged conduct but need not disclose another student's confidential records.

The student has five business days to respond. The instructor then submits a report to the Academic Integrity Officer with the student's response and relevant evidence.

The instructor may assign a temporary grade of NG while review is pending. A final academic penalty is not entered until the process is complete.

- Student response period: 5 business days.
- Temporary grade: NG.
- The central office maintains prior-case records.

Reference: NSU-INTEGRITY-2026 | CURRENT

3. Findings and Sanctions

The standard of proof is preponderance of the evidence. A first minor violation may result in a warning and assignment revision. More serious or repeated violations may result in a zero, reduced course grade, integrity probation, suspension, or expulsion.

An instructor recommends an academic consequence. The Academic Integrity Officer determines institutional sanctions after reviewing prior findings.

A student found not responsible receives a corrected grade without a misconduct notation.

Violation context	Possible response
First minor violation	Warning and revision
Substantial cheating or fabrication	Zero or reduced course grade
Repeated or severe misconduct	Probation, suspension, or expulsion

Reference: NSU-INTEGRITY-2026 | CURRENT

4. Appeals and Records

A student may appeal within ten calendar days of the written decision. Grounds are a material procedural error, significant new evidence unavailable earlier, or a sanction clearly disproportionate to the finding.

An appeal is not a new hearing and disagreement with credibility findings alone is insufficient. The Academic Integrity Appeals Panel normally responds within twenty business days.

Integrity records are retained for seven years after the case closes. Expulsion records are retained permanently.

- Appeal deadline: 10 calendar days.
- Normal appeal response: 20 business days.
- Most records retained: 7 years.

Reference: NSU-INTEGRITY-2026 | CURRENT